NICOLENE ELIZABETH NEL

Insurance Portfolio Specialist | Client Advisory & Operations Professional | Founder – Simply Templates Designs

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Internationally Mobile | Remote-Ready

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Insurance Portfolio & Risk Management
- Personal & Commercial Insurance Advisory Services
- Policy Structuring & Underwriting Negotiation
- Claims Lifecycle Management & Dispute Resolution
- Client Relationship Management & Advisory Services
- Complaint Resolution & Ombudsman Submission Support
- FAIS Compliance & Regulatory Documentation Governance
- Policy Administration, Renewals & Endorsements
- Insurer & Stakeholder Liaison
- Commission Reconciliation & Financial Oversight
- Executive Operations & Practice Administration
- Business Documentation & Process Design
- Brand Identity, Marketing Assets & Digital Content Development
- Virtual Administrative & Business Support
- Project Coordination & Client Service Delivery
- AI-Assisted Workflow & Digital Tools

ABOUT ME

A business professional with over 19 years of client-facing experience in insurance advisory, operations support, and documentation. Managed personal and commercial insurance portfolios for 300+ clients, focusing on risk advisory and claims coordination. Known for effective communication, dispute resolution, and stakeholder coordination. Founder of Simply Templates Designs, delivering structured documentation systems and branding assets that streamline business operations. Highly organized, adaptable, and skilled at mastering new systems in fast-paced environments.

EXPERIENCE

Insurance Specialist – Stepp Consult | Remote (June 2025 – Present)
Reason for Leaving: Seeking long-term executive operations alignment.

Provide full-service insurance brokerage support to personal and commercial clients within a regulated advisory environment, managing portfolios, underwriting placements, claims coordination, and compliance documentation.

- Manage personal and commercial insurance portfolios including motor, property, liability, and specialist risk products, conducting risk reviews and identifying coverage gaps to optimise client protection.
- Advise individuals and businesses on appropriate insurance solutions while preparing and processing new business applications, renewals, endorsements, and underwriting documentation.
- Liaise with insurers and underwriters to obtain quotations, negotiate premiums and terms, and structure policies across multiple insurers to achieve optimal coverage and pricing.
- Review policy wording, endorsements, and special terms to ensure suitability and regulatory compliance.
- Manage the full claims lifecycle, including claim reporting, documentation preparation, submission to insurers, and liaison with assessors and service providers through to settlement.
- Maintain FAIS-compliant documentation and audit-ready client files while ensuring consistent communication between clients, insurers, and stakeholders during policy servicing and dispute resolution.
- Reconcile insurer commission statements against active policies, investigate discrepancies with underwriters, coordinate with accounts regarding commission allocation, and support business development through social media marketing and branded content creation via Simply Templates Designs.

Executive Operations Partner | Documentation & Visual Strategy Specialist | Founder – Simply Templates Designs | Remote (March 2020 – Present)
Reason for Leaving: Ongoing consultancy alongside core roles.

Founded and operate a freelance documentation and design consultancy supporting entrepreneurs, consultants, and small businesses with structured business documentation, branding systems, and marketing materials.

- Design branding and visual identity assets including logos, stationery, social media graphics, and marketing materials.
- Develop structured business documentation such as business plans, proposals, contracts, policies, and operational templates.
- Create editable Canva template systems allowing businesses to manage their own marketing and document workflows.
- Produce professional newsletters, reports, presentations, and communication materials for businesses and community organisations.
- Provide virtual administrative support, including invoice drafting, quotation preparation, email communication, and document formatting.
- Design CVs, professional profiles, and executive documentation to improve professional presentation.
- Assist new businesses with branding setup, document systems, and launch-ready marketing materials.
- Manage multiple client projects from concept to delivery while maintaining structured revision and approval processes.
- Utilise AI-assisted design and workflow tools to enhance efficiency, clarity, and document presentation.

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INSURANCE EXPERTISE

Insurance Expertise

- Personal Lines Insurance
- Commercial Insurance
- Motor & Non-Motor Claims
- Property & Liability Cover
- Policy Structuring & Placement
- Risk Assessment & Coverage Optimisation
- Portfolio Management & Policy Reviews
- Claims Documentation & Escalation Support

Insurer & Underwriter Experience

Experience liaising with and placing policies through major South African insurers and specialist underwriting managers including:

- Discovery Insure
- Santam
- Old Mutual Insure
- Hollard
- Momentum Insure
- Auto & General
- Renasa
- Leppard
- Western National
- Camargue
- CIB
- MUA Insurance
- OneSure
- SHA Risk Specialists

Insurance Specialist – Addsure | Remote (October 2018 – June 2025)
Reason for Leaving: Relocated to KwaZulu-Natal due to a family health matter; role required Cape Town proximity.

Provided comprehensive insurance advisory and brokerage support to personal and commercial clients within a regulated environment.

- Advised clients on appropriate insurance solutions based on risk exposure, clearly explaining policy terms, conditions, exclusions, and coverage options.
- Prepared and processed new business applications, renewals, endorsements, and policy amendments while maintaining structured and accurate client records.
- Managed motor and non-motor claims from notification through submission and follow-up, liaising with insurers, assessors, and service providers.
- Maintained FAIS-compliant documentation and audit-ready client files in accordance with regulatory and internal governance requirements.
- Managed client queries, coverage reviews, and complaint resolution, including compiling documentation and assisting with Ombudsman complaint submissions where required.
- Liaised with insurers, compliance officers, and internal stakeholders to facilitate fair and timely resolution of claims and client concerns.
- Managed insurer commission reconciliation by reviewing monthly statements, maintaining an Excel tracking system, investigating discrepancies with underwriters, and coordinating with accounts to ensure correct commission allocation.

Insurance Specialist – Faulds & Associates | Richards Bay (July 2012 – October 2018)
Reason for Leaving: Relocated to Cape Town and accepted a new insurance advisory opportunity with Addsure.

Promoted internally from Receptionist & Financial Advisor Executive Assistant to Insurance Advisor in recognition of strong administrative, client service, and operational capabilities.

- Managed personal and commercial insurance portfolios including motor, property, and liability policies, advising clients on appropriate coverage based on their risk exposure.
- Prepared quotations and processed new business applications, renewals, endorsements, and policy amendments while maintaining accurate client records and documentation.
- Liaised with insurers and underwriters to obtain quotations and structure suitable insurance solutions for clients.
- Assisted clients with motor and non-motor claims, including preparation and submission of supporting documentation.
- Maintained regular client communication to review coverage, update policies, and ensure ongoing suitability of insurance solutions.
- Maintained compliant client files and documentation in accordance with brokerage and regulatory requirements.
- Built long-term client relationships through proactive service and clear communication while assisting with basic long-term insurance solutions where appropriate.
- Early Role – Receptionist & Financial Advisor Executive Assistant
- Managed front-office reception, client communications, and appointment scheduling for financial advisors.
- Assisted with preparation of quotations, client documentation, and onboarding of new clients while maintaining structured policy records.

Professional Development
- Self-funded Short-Term Insurance Qualification (NQF 4).
- Completed RE5 Representative Exam.
- Completed 90 credits toward Wealth Management qualification (60 credits remaining to complete Life Brokerage qualification).

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TECHNOLOGY & PLATFORMS

Office & Productivity Systems

- Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook)
- Advanced Excel (Commission Reconciliation, Reporting & Data Tracking)
- PDF Documentation & Digital File Management

Insurance Platforms

- Old Mutual Insure Online
- Santam Broker Portal
- Discovery Insure Online
- CRM & Client Management
- @Work CRM System

Client Documentation & Policy Administration Systems

Communication & Collaboration

- Microsoft Teams
- Zoom

Digital Forms & Data Collection

- Google Forms
- Jotform

AI & Digital Productivity Tools

- ChatGPT AI
- Microsoft Copilot AI
- Meta AI
- AI-Assisted Content Creation & Workflow Support

Design & Content Tools

- Canva Design Platform
- Digital Marketing & Visual Content Creation

EDUCATION

- RE5 Representative Exam – Moonstone
- National Certificate: Short-Term Insurance (NQF Level 4) – Damelin
- Continuing Professional Development (CPD)
- Matric – Richards Bay High School

Executive Assistant & Practice Operations Lead – Old Mutual | Empangeni

(May 2008 – July 2012)

Reason for Leaving: Advisor passed away; subsequently accepted an opportunity with Faulds & Associates following a professional referral.

Provided comprehensive executive and operational support to a financial advisor, managing the day-to-day administration, client servicing, and documentation requirements of the advisory practice.

- Managed the advisor's schedule, client appointments, and meeting coordination while providing primary administrative support for the practice.
- Prepared insurance and investment quotations, client correspondence, and supporting documentation for client consultations.
- Maintained structured client records and ensured documentation complied with company and regulatory requirements.
- Assisted with onboarding new clients, gathering compliance documentation and preparing client files for policy processing.
- Liaised with insurers, investment providers, and internal departments to facilitate policy processing, claims administration, and client servicing.
- Managed ongoing client communication, responded to queries, coordinated follow-ups, and supported business development through preparation of sales materials and proposals while maintaining strict confidentiality of sensitive client information.

Receptionist | Reservationist | Night Auditor (Relief) - Richards Hotel – 4★ International Hotel | Richards Bay (December 2006 – May 2008)

Reason for Leaving: Left the role due to pregnancy and the demanding shift hours associated with hospitality operations.

Provided front-office guest services and operational support within a high-volume international hospitality environment.

- Managed guest check-ins, check-outs, and reservation enquiries while maintaining professional front-desk operations.
- Successfully upsold premium room categories and higher tariff bookings, maximising room revenue during high-demand periods.
- Handled guest complaints and service concerns professionally, ensuring timely resolution and maintaining high levels of guest satisfaction.
- Coordinated with the kitchen team to prepare custom travel hampers for guests departing on excursions, delivering personalised guest service.
- Performed night audit relief duties, reconciling daily financial transactions, balancing accounts, and maintaining accurate guest records while coordinating with housekeeping and operations teams.

Key Career Achievements

- Managed and serviced diversified personal and commercial insurance portfolios exceeding 300 active clients.
- Successfully coordinated motor and non-motor claims from notification to settlement, ensuring efficient client support during complex claims processes.
- Built and maintained long-term client relationships through proactive communication, advisory support, and effective dispute resolution.
- Developed structured documentation systems, branding assets, and business templates through Simply Templates Designs, supporting entrepreneurs and small businesses.
- Maintained strict FAIS-compliant documentation and audit-ready client files across brokerage environments.
- Developed company manuals and enhanced compliance and operational documentation, improving organisational consistency and regulatory readiness.

I believe in treating everyone with fairness, honesty, and respect. Integrity and transparency guide my professional decisions, and I maintain a firm commitment to ethical conduct. If something is incorrect, unethical, or unlawful, I address it openly and professionally without compromise.

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